

C-4 Analytics, v. Duff

Automotive digital-marketing data, reporting and workflow systems, including a written information security program and the product/AI/engineering systems used to run dealership marketing operations.

Independent preliminary research based on public information.

FILED	FORUM	DOCKET	MATTER
2026-08-19	D. Mass.	1:26-cv-13844	Trade Secret

Prepared 2026-08-25. No attorney or expert contacted. Availability, interest, compensation, and conflicts not checked.

Public filing, likely recipient, and technical frame

CAPTION	C-4 Analytics, LLC v. Duff et al.
FORUM / DOCKET	D. Mass. / 1:26-cv-13844
FILED / TYPE	2026-08-19 / trade secret
PUBLIC DOCKET	Open docket

VERIFIED PUBLIC RECORD

C-4 Analytics, LLC v. Duff et al., No. 1:26-cv-13844, filed 2026-08-19 in D. Mass..

LIKELY RESEARCH PURCHASER

Ryan W. Jaziri - Morgan, Brown & Joy, LLP; named matter counsel. Jaziri filed the complaint, emergency TRO/preliminary-injunction motion, supporting memorandum, declarations, and amended declarations for C-4 Analytics, making him the clearest early-stage research purchaser.

rjaziri@morganbrown.com - publicly listed on the [official firm biography](#); not inferred.

TECHNICAL FRAME

Automotive digital-marketing data, reporting and workflow systems, including a written information security program and the product/AI/engineering systems used to run dealership marketing operations.

Secondary-source limitation: This is a preliminary technical frame based on public sources. Filed pleadings, claim charts, discovery, source code, product versions, and admissible evidence must control. [Open public synopsis](#)

Questions likely to require expert input

This issue map is a research plan, not a legal conclusion. The filed complaint, patent exhibits, intrinsic record, and discovery must control.

01 Which datasets, models, reporting schemas, workflow logic, AI features, and security controls are alleged trade secrets rather than general marketing practice?

Which datasets, models, reporting schemas, workflow logic, AI features, and security controls are alleged trade secrets rather than general marketing practice?

Potential evidence: Pleadings and claim charts; source code or engineering records; product and version documentation; standards and prior art; reproducible testing; and fact or technical testimony as applicable.

02 How were dealership data ingested, normalized, attributed, reported, and protected across the product stack?

How were dealership data ingested, normalized, attributed, reported, and protected across the product stack?

Potential evidence: Pleadings and claim charts; source code or engineering records; product and version documentation; standards and prior art; reproducible testing; and fact or technical testimony as applicable.

03 Could the disputed workflow be independently developed from public APIs, common ad-tech tools, and industry-standard analytics methods?

Could the disputed workflow be independently developed from public APIs, common ad-tech tools, and industry-standard analytics methods?

Potential evidence: Pleadings and claim charts; source code or engineering records; product and version documentation; standards and prior art; reproducible testing; and fact or technical testimony as applicable.

Questions likely to require expert input

Candidates 1-2 for further diligence

Ranked for preliminary research priority based on subject-matter fit, relevant public work, testimony, and visible diligence burden. This is not a retention recommendation.

01 Ryan Dew

Associate Professor of Marketing, Wharton School, University of Pennsylvania

TECHNICAL FIT

Fit for data-driven marketing systems, ML, customer analytics, and interpretability of reporting workflows.

RELEVANT WORK

Researches machine learning, Bayesian methods, unstructured data, preference measurement, and marketing decisions.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No candidate-specific expert report, declaration, deposition, or trial testimony was located in the bounded public-source review.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

Academic methods emphasis; dealership-platform architecture and security controls may require a separate software expert.

[Source 1](#)

[Draft email](#) | ryandew@wharton.upenn.edu | [public email source](#)

02 N. Syam

Robert J. Trulaske Sr. Associate Professor of Marketing, University of Missouri

TECHNICAL FIT

Fit for AI/ML in marketing and sales, pipeline analytics, and decision-support workflows.

RELEVANT WORK

Coauthor of a practitioner reference on machine learning and AI for marketing and sales.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No candidate-specific expert report, declaration, deposition, or trial testimony was located in the bounded public-source review.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

No automotive-dealership implementation experience is identified in the public profile.

[Source 1](#)

[Draft email](#) | syamn@missouri.edu | [public email source](#)

Candidates 3-4 for further diligence

03 Charles Hofacker

Persis E. Rockwood Professor of Marketing, Florida State University

TECHNICAL FIT

Fit for digital strategy, marketing analytics, AI, CRM, and software-mediated marketing.

RELEVANT WORK

Publishes across digital marketing, AI, customer relationship management, voice interfaces, and technology.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No candidate-specific expert report, declaration, deposition, or trial testimony was located in the bounded public-source review.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

Broad strategy profile; source-code, cybersecurity, and forensic issues are outside the strongest fit.

[Source 1](#)

[Draft email](#) | chofack@business.fsu.edu | [public email source](#)

04 Liye Ma

Professor of Marketing, University of Maryland Robert H. Smith School of Business

TECHNICAL FIT

Strong fit for AI/ML, digital marketing, mobile/social platforms, and optimization of marketing decisions.

RELEVANT WORK

Coauthored Machine Learning and AI in Marketing and publishes in Marketing Science, JMR, and Management Science.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No candidate-specific expert report, declaration, deposition, or trial testimony was located in the bounded public-source review.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

May be less suited to WISP compliance or incident-response testimony.

[Source 1](#)

[Draft email](#) | liyema@umd.edu | [public email source](#)

Candidates 5-6 for further diligence

05 Alice Li

Associate Professor of Marketing, Ohio State University Fisher College of Business

TECHNICAL FIT

Strong fit for marketing measurement, attribution, AI, ML, fragmented data, and customer journeys.

RELEVANT WORK

Research and teaching cover multi-touch attribution, marketing-mix modeling, and cookie-free measurement.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No candidate-specific expert report, declaration, deposition, or trial testimony was located in the bounded public-source review.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

No specific dealer-management-system work is shown.

[Source 1](#)

[Draft email](#) | li.815@osu.edu | [public email source](#)

06 Zhuping Liu

Associate Professor of Marketing, Baruch College

TECHNICAL FIT

Fit for big-data marketing, text ML, econometrics, market research, and analytics pipelines.

RELEVANT WORK

Public profile lists big data, ML with text, Bayesian statistics, field experiments, and marketing analytics.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No candidate-specific expert report, declaration, deposition, or trial testimony was located in the bounded public-source review.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

Primarily methodological; operational information-security practices are not a stated specialty.

[Source 1](#)

[Draft email](#) | zhuping.liu@baruch.cuny.edu | [public email source](#)

Candidates 7-8 for further diligence

07 Ishita Chakraborty

Assistant Professor of Marketing, Wisconsin School of Business

TECHNICAL FIT

Fit for generative AI, online platforms, unstructured data, and algorithmic market-research tools.

RELEVANT WORK

Publishes on AI-enabled consumer insight and develops real-time tools from unstructured data.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No candidate-specific expert report, declaration, deposition, or trial testimony was located in the bounded public-source review.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

Early-career relative to other candidates and not dealership-specific.

[Source 1](#)

[Draft email](#) | ishita.chakraborty@wisc.edu | [public email source](#)

08 Kelly Cutler

Associate Professor, Medill School, Northwestern University

TECHNICAL FIT

Practical fit for search, social, programmatic, retargeting, digital analytics, and measurement workflows.

RELEVANT WORK

More than 20 years in digital marketing and digital media, combining industry practice and teaching.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No candidate-specific expert report, declaration, deposition, or trial testimony was located in the bounded public-source review.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

Industry-facing profile may present conflicts; technical source-code depth is not established.

[Source 1](#)

[Draft email](#) | kelly.cutler@northwestern.edu | [public email source](#)

Candidates 9-10 for further diligence

09 Edward C. Malthouse

Erastus Otis Haven Professor and research director, Northwestern Medill

TECHNICAL FIT

Fit for big data, CRM, recommender systems, predictive analytics, and digital customer measurement.

RELEVANT WORK

Researches engagement, digital/social/mobile media, lifetime value, recommendation, and predictive models.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No candidate-specific expert report, declaration, deposition, or trial testimony was located in the bounded public-source review.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

May be stronger on analytics validity than product engineering or cybersecurity controls.

[Source 1](#)

[Draft email](#) | ecm@northwestern.edu | [public email source](#)

10 Catherine Tucker

Sloan Distinguished Professor of Management and Professor of Marketing, MIT Sloan

TECHNICAL FIT

Strong fit for personalized advertising, privacy controls, digital platforms, and data-use economics.

RELEVANT WORK

Published empirical work on social networks, personalized advertising, and privacy controls.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No candidate-specific expert report, declaration, deposition, or trial testimony was located in the bounded public-source review.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

Economics/marketing lens rather than implementation-level forensic software analysis.

[Source 1](#)

[Draft email](#) | cetucker@mit.edu | [public email source](#)

Preliminary candidates; no conflicts or availability determination

- Run party, affiliate, counsel, inventor, funder, and technology conflicts.
- Confirm testimony history, exclusions, compensation, publications, patents, and deposition performance.
- Investigate licensing, grants, consulting, commercial interests, and prior technical positions.
- Confirm role fit, availability, and interest only after counsel authorizes outreach.

ONGOING MATTER-SPECIFIC RESEARCH

Flint Witness Research works in the post-filing window, turning pleadings and public technical records into issue maps, researched candidate slates, and diligence starting points as the case develops.

[Schedule a 15-minute conversation](#)

CORE SOURCES

Public docket: <https://dockets.justia.com/docket/massachusetts/madce/1%3A2026cv13844/305184>

Official attorney biography and email: <https://www.morganbrown.com/attorney/ryan-w-iaziri/?print=PDF>

Public technical context source: <https://dockets.justia.com/docket/massachusetts/madce/1%3A2026cv13844/305184>

LIMITATIONS

This is a preliminary technical frame based on public sources. Filed pleadings, claim charts, discovery, source code, product versions, and admissible evidence must control.

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